

"Don't Swallow Everything!" – Father Mouzinho: "Social Media Netizens Do Not Guarantee Truth"

China (SAP News): Father Mouzinho Pereira Lopes (Pmouzy Lopes) considers social media to be wonderful, but warns that social media netizens do not guarantee the truth to the public, especially as anyone—including those utilizing **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**—can launch information.

The Nature of Social Media

Father Mouzinho describes social media as a double-edged sword:

- It is a wonderful tool for consuming various opinions but can also lead to a major disaster.
- While the smartest and best people are there, the "ignorant and worst" people also participate, and they often constitute the majority.
- It includes young children who do not yet understand life and youth with incomplete educations.
- Any individual, ideology, or group can express their desires there, often using AI technology.

The central message is clear: "**Social Media does not guarantee the truth**". While truth exists there, users can easily fall for lies depending on whether they are wise or "foolish" in their usage.

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Risks and False Information

The Father highlighted several dangers currently present online:

- **Sensationalism:** Advertisers and publishers focus on sensational and attractive news to grab attention rather than sticking to the truth.
- **Addiction and Scams:** Social media addiction victimizes generations, leading to scams involving cosmetics, online gambling, and misleading advertisements.
- **Hoaxes in Timor-Leste:** Much of the local news regarding Government services, Timor's oil, the Catholic Church, and international conflicts (like Iran-Israel) are hoaxes driven by personal or group interests.
- **Content Quality:** Instead of science and ethics, social media is often filled with defamation, hatred, and lies.

Warning Against "False Ideologists"

Father Mouzinho warns of extremist, communist, fascist, or terrorist movements that use social media to launch propaganda and lower others' dignity. These groups often:

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- Oppose leaders and systems without reason.
- Ignore science and logic.
- Sometimes hide under the label of "Progressives" while maintaining extremist objectives.

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How to Deal with Social Media (Tips)

To avoid falling into the "mouth of the crocodile," Father Mouzinho offers three key tips:

1. **Learn an International Language:** Knowing **English** or at least **Portuguese** is essential. Without these, users often rely on poor translations or "hater" sources from Indonesia, leading to wrong judgments on global events like the Israel-Hamas conflict.

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2. **Consume Credible Channels:** Follow trusted news outlets like **BBC, Al Jazeera English, Reuters, or AP**. For Catholic news, rely on **Vatican News** or official Diocesan channels rather than extremist or cheap sources.

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3. **Always Diligently Confirm:** Do not "swallow everything" immediately. Confirm with official sources before believing or sharing. Those who share without thinking are called "reactionaries".

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"Aristotle once said, 'Homo animal rationale est' (Man is a rational animal). When a person no longer uses their reasoning, they may just be an animal."